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Introduction to vSaaS

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1 Software-as-a-Service (SaaS) and Validated SaaS

Validated SaaS extends the concept of SaaS for customers who need a longer release cycle to validate their software to a regulator.

Software-as-a-service (SaaS) is a way of delivering software applications over the Internet versus software bundled and loaded to the local drive of a computer. Among its advantages is speed. Because SaaS software developers own both the development and deployment structures, we can push to production quickly.

For a small set of SAP SuccessFactors Learning customers, however, the speed of SaaS is faster than their validation schedule. Validation is not standard across industries or customers but it usually requires highly detailed documentation. The documentation is time consuming to produce. It usually takes three-to-six months.

As a result of the validation requirements, customers cannot receive quarterly release updates. Instead, these customers need an annual release schedule. For these customers, we offer SaaS at a slower cadence and with some additional validation reporting features. This allows time for them to produce the documentation they need to meet their validation requirements.

The slower release cadence and additional validation reporting is called Validated SaaS, or vSaaS. Validated SaaS is a consensus-based service designed to meet the FDA 21 CFR Part 11/validation requirements of life science industry.

1.1 Software Validation

Software validation is common for some types of SAP SuccessFactors Learning customers who are overseen by a regulatory body.

Validation is governed by guidelines from the Federal Food and Drug Administration (FDA) and is prevalent in the life sciences industries. The goal is to document procedures and processes to demonstrate that results are consistent. Consistent results lead to a better controlled environment for the development of products. Validation ensures FDA compliance.

1.2 Validated SaaS

Validated SaaS has benefits for highly regulated environments because it provides a way to comply with regulatory bodies.

Validated SaaS provides a consensus-based service designed to meet the FDA 21 CFR Part 11/validation requirements. Life Science Industries can reduce costs and IT resource needs. This process also ensures FDA compliance and GxP processes.

Specific benefits of Validated SaaS for SAP SuccessFactors Learning customers include:

- A dedicated product track and measured cadence that we specifically designed for life science customers. Your patches drop on the dedicated schedule.
- Automated learning assignments with flexible criteria that are unique for the LMS options.
- Support for FDA 21 CFR part 11 and multi-part e-signatures.
- Visibility for managers into compliance training status and activities

1.3 Learning Validated SaaS Release Schedule

SAP SuccessFactors Learning validated Software as a Service (vSaaS) releases annually and includes the half-yearly release from the previous year.

Note

All dates are approximate. They change slightly with each cycle to accommodate deployment windows and adjustments to standard releases. The exact schedule for each year is posted in the SAP Community. Search for "Upgrade and Patch Schedule" in the [Validated SaaS SAP SuccessFactors Learning Communication User Group](#).

Environment	Release	Approximate Upgrade Date
Sandbox	1H release patch 4, inclusive of prior year's 2H release	Middle of May
Preview	1H release patch 4, inclusive of prior year's 2H release	Early June
Sandbox	1H release patch 21	Early September
Preview	1H release patch 21	Middle of September
Production and Pre-Production	1H release patch 21	Late October / Early November
Sandbox	1H VSaaS Patch p29	Late November
Preview	1H VSaaS Patch p29	Middle of December
Production and Pre-Production	1H VSaaS Patch p29	Late December / Early January
Sandbox	1H VSaaS Patch p30	Early February
Preview	1H VSaaS Patch p30	Middle of February
Production and Pre-Production	1H VSaaS Patch p30	Early March
Sandbox	1H VSaaS Patch p31	Middle of March
Preview	1H VSaaS Patch p31	Late March / Early April
Production and Pre-Production	1H VSaaS Patch p31	Late April

1.4 Validated SaaS Qualification

Validated SaaS customers show installation, operational, and performance qualification.

As a Validated SaaS customer, you typically need to demonstrate qualification in these areas:

- Installation Qualification (IQ): Demonstrates that the process or equipment meets all specifications, is installed correctly, and all required components and documentation needed for continued operation are installed and in place.
- Operational Qualification (OQ): Demonstrates that all facets of the process or equipment are operating correctly.
- Performance Qualification (PQ): Demonstrates that the process or equipment performs as intended in a consistent manner over time.

Installation Qualification (IQ) Reports are relevant to SAP SuccessFactors. The SF Operations team provides documentation of initial set up of the application and database that demonstrates all of the required steps were followed for proper installation in the environment.

Operational Qualification (OQ) and Performance Qualification (PQ) are relevant to Validated SaaS clients. With OQ, customers test application functionality and document actual-versus-expected results, similar to User Acceptance Testing (UAT). With PQ reports, customers test application functionality based on their business processes, use cases, and data to ensure the product will work as designed.

1.5 Validated SaaS Community

We offer a space for members of the Validated SaaS community to share best practices, thoughts, and ideas.

As a Validated SaaS customer, you can share ideas and procedures with other validated customers in the [SAP SuccessFactors Learning Life Sciences User Group](#) .

1.6 VSaaS to Platform: Tested Integration Points

If you are a vSaaS customer, you should understand tested integration points between SAP SuccessFactors Learning and core SAP SuccessFactors so that you know the rate of test.

Although the Validated Software as a Service (VSaaS) solution is tested annually, SAP SuccessFactors platform is updated half-yearly. For customers who run the VSaaS Learning Management System (LMS) integrated with SAP SuccessFactors platform, we test the integration points on a half-yearly basis. We do not test every integration point, only the following:

- SAP SuccessFactors platform themes supported in LMS
- LMS & CDP Integration
- Learning TODOs
 - My Team

- Learning History Portal
- Curriculum Portal
- Learning to development goal association
- JAM integration
- Single Sign On (SSO) – User logs into SAP SuccessFactors platform and clicks the Learning menu
- SAP SuccessFactors platform-LMS User connector
- SAP SuccessFactors platform-LMS Competency connector
- Employee Profile

1.7 Sample IQ Report

An IQ Report (Operations Automated Deployment Report) is best understood by seeing an example.

Look at this sample IQ report to see how the deployment report looks for Validated SaaS customers. https://help.sap.com/doc/078db1fab432493c8733c04c3bef2f32/0/en-US/Ops_Auto_Deploy_Rpt_Sample.pdf

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